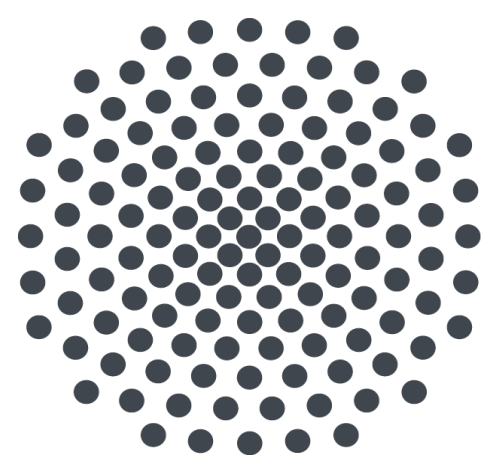




What is Populism?

While the definition of populism has been of some debate, in recent years, scholars have increasingly converged on *the ideational definition* (Rooduijn, 2019). Populism concerns an antagonistic relationship between the “corrupt elite” and the “virtuous people” and thus rests on two central concepts: **anti-elitism** and **people-centrism** (Mudde, 2004).

Why YouTube?

- YouTube is the second most important site for young Germans to obtain news and information, trailing only behind Google (Feierabend et al., 2018)
- Compared to other Social Media platforms, YouTube is under-researched

Data

- All videos of all official party channels from December 6, 2017 – January 20, 2024
- 9,394 videos, totaling 1,485 hours and 708,504 sentences
- Videos are transcribed using whisper-v3-large (Radford et al., 2022)
- Populist dimensions are annotated using PopBERT (Erhard et al., forthcoming)

Literature

Erhard, L., Hanke, S., Remer, U., Falenska, A., Heiberger, R. H. (forthcoming). PopBERT. Detecting Populism and Its Host Ideologies in the German Bundestag. *Political Analysis*.

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Hawkins, K. A., & Rovira Kaltwasser, C. (2017). The Ideational Approach to Populism. *Latin American Research Review*, 52(4), 513–528.

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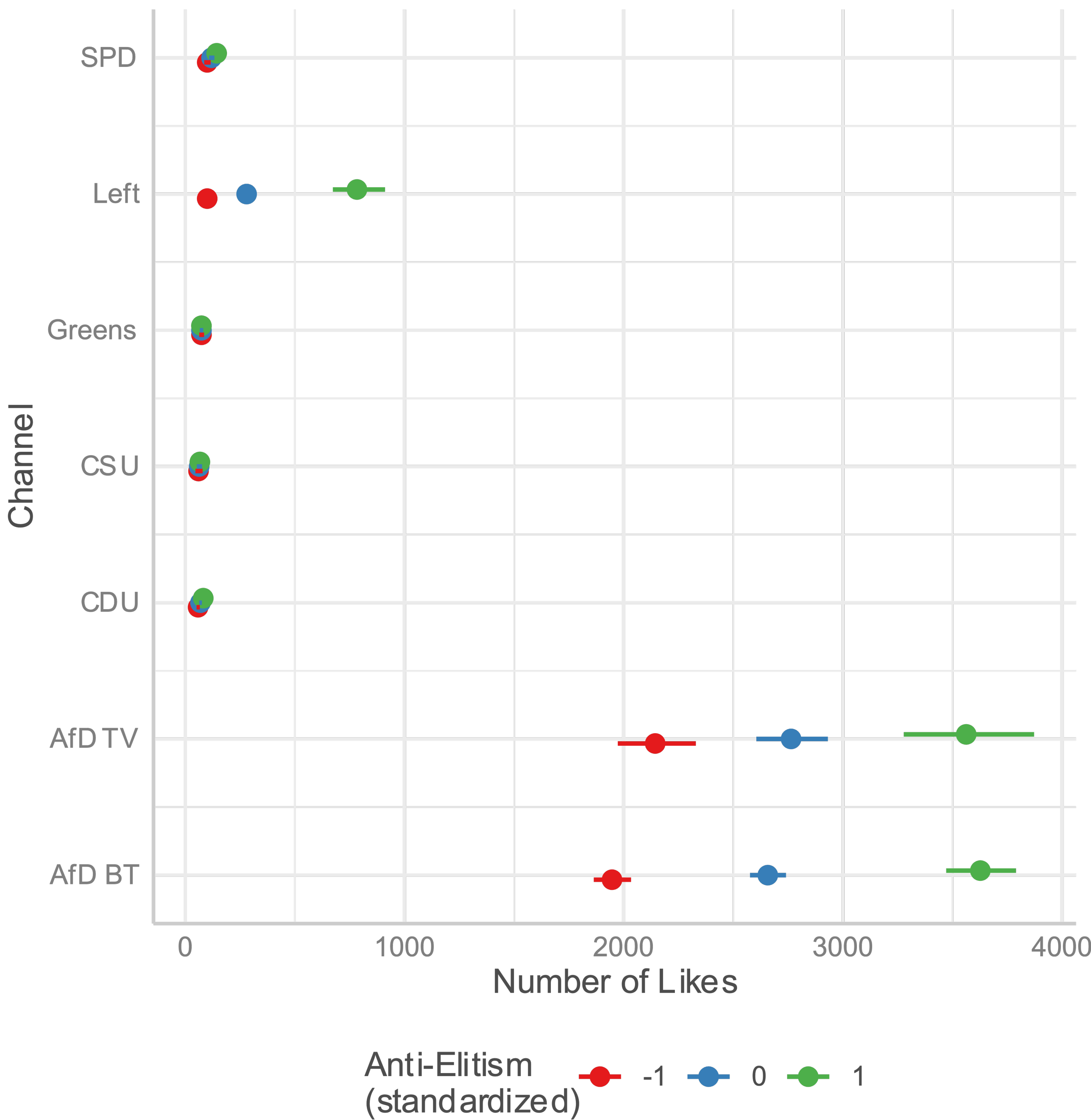
Radford, A., Kim, J. W., Xu, T., Brockman, G., McLeavey, C., & Sutskever, I. (2022). Robust speech recognition via large-scale weak supervision. *arXiv*.

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Results

- Each AfD Channel has **more than double the followers** of all other parties combined.
- The number of likes of a video correlates positively with the proportion of anti-elitist sentences **only for channels of populist parties**

Marginal Effects of Anti-Elitism



	AfD BT	AfD TV	CDU	CSU	FDP	Greens	Left	SPD
N Videos	5215	1442	613	141	461	455	429	469
N Followers	388,000	250,000	21,900	5,170	23,300	26,100	29,000	24,200
N Sents	295,255	142,810	53,017	10,337	36,094	45,667	45,912	65,523
N Anti-Elite Sents	39,747 (13.4%)	17,056 (11.9%)	918 (1.7%)	286 (2.8%)	1,403 (3.8%)	1,415 (3.1%)	2,420 (5.3%)	1,380 (2.1%)
N People-Centric Sents	5,984 (2.0%)	3,592 (2.5%)	1,419 (2.6%)	245 (2.4%)	886 (2.5%)	1,314 (2.9%)	1,374 (3.0%)	2,163 (3.3%)
Avg. Likes	3,861.4	3,652.1	67.7	36.1	0.5	75.7	260.0	100.5
Avg. Views	45,749.6	43,601.4	9,165.2	22,944.1	5,580.9	4,459.9	10,734.1	5,204.8
Avg. Video Duration (sec)	436.5	666.1	661.3	453.4	670.5	901.3	878.3	1133.0
Avg. Comments	397.6	398.4	43.1	7.6	0.7	0.2	46.3	25.7